

Man on the Tree

A man saw a **ripe** mango at the top of a tree, and **climbed up** to get it.

He had almost reached the fruit when he lost his **footing**, and fell.

He saved himself by **grabbing** a branch. But he was still not out of danger. The branch was too high above the ground for a safe fall. If he **let go**, if the branch broke (it was not too thick) the fall could **cripple** him for life.



Terrified by his **predicament**, he hung on **grimly** and **shouted** for help.

Presently, a white-haired **sage** came that way. Seeing the man **dangling** on the tree he picked up a **clod** of mud and threw it at him.

“W-Why did you do that?” **yelled** the man, **startled**.

The sage did not answer. Instead, he began **pelting** the man with clods of mud, laughing **uproariously** every time he scored a direct hit.

The man on the tree became very angry.

“You think you can take advantage of my **helplessness**!” he **screamed**. “I’ll show you!”

Straining every sinew, he shifted his **grip** on the branch to move closer to the **trunk**.

Slowly, but with a **determination born out** of his rage he **inched** towards the trunk till he was close enough to **embrace** it. Once he had gained the trunk, climbing down was an easy matter.

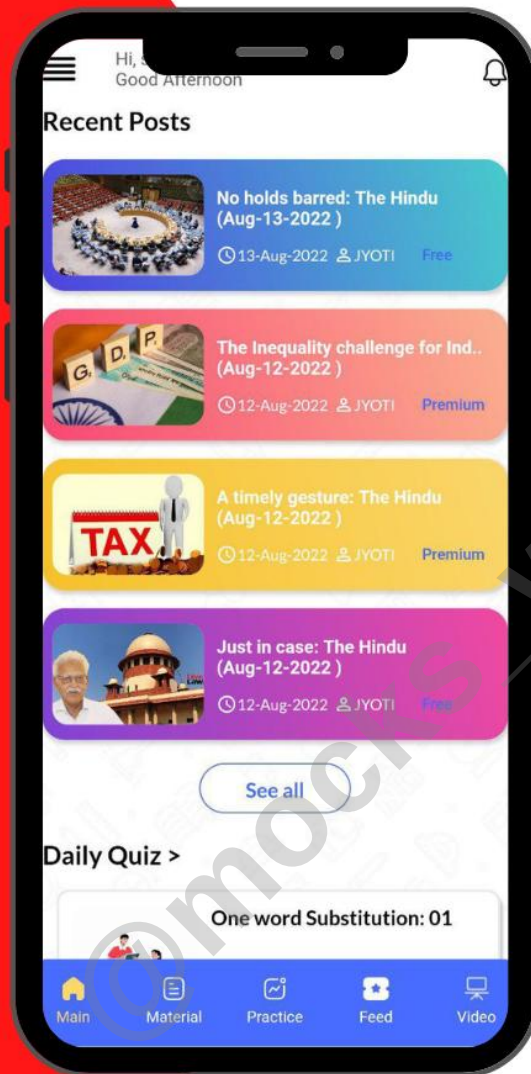
“Now you rascal,” **roared** the man, **advancing menacingly** towards the sage, “tell me why you were throwing mud at me!”

“To help you **get down** of course,” smiled the sage. “If I had not made you angry, you would still be hanging on to that tree, **paralyzed** by fear.”

Vocabulary

1. **Ripe** (adjective) – mature, ready, developed, seasoned, mellow पका हुआ
2. **Climb up** (phrasal verb) – ascend, scale, go up, mount, rise ऊपर चढ़ना
3. **Footing** (noun) – balance, stance, grip, stability, support पैर जमाना / संतुलन
4. **Grab** (verb) – seize, clutch, snatch, take, grasp पकड़ना
5. **Let go** (phrasal verb) – release, free, drop, relinquish, unhand छोड़ देना
6. **Cripple** (verb) – disable, injure, impair, maim, incapacitate अपंग करना
7. **Terrify** (verb) – frighten, scare, alarm, horrify, petrify भयभीत करना
8. **Predicament** (noun) – difficulty, dilemma, problem, crisis, plight कठिन परिस्थिति
9. **Grimly** (adverb) – sternly, harshly, seriously, firmly, severely कठोरता से
10. **Shout** (verb) – yell, cry, call, scream, holler चिल्लाना
11. **Sage** (noun) – wise man, philosopher, saint, thinker, guru ऋषि / ज्ञानी
12. **Dangle** (verb) – hang, swing, sway, droop, suspend लटकना
13. **Clod** (noun) – lump, chunk, mass, piece, lump of earth मिट्टी का ढेला
14. **Yell** (verb) – shout, cry, scream, holler, bellow चिल्लाना
15. **Startle** (verb) – surprise, shock, alarm, frighten, unsettle चौंका देना
16. **Pelt** (verb) – throw, hurl, bombard, lob, fling मारना / फेंकना
17. **Uproariously** (adverb) – loudly, boisterously, noisily, raucously, hilariously शोरगुल से / ठहाके लगाकर
18. **Helplessness** (noun) – powerlessness, incapacity, weakness, inability, vulnerability लाचारी
19. **Scream** (verb) – shriek, cry, yell, wail, screech चीखना
20. **Strain every sinew** (noun) – exert fully, make every effort, work hard, push oneself, try one's utmost पूरी ताकत लगाना
21. **Grip** (noun) – hold, grasp, clasp, clutch, grasp पकड़
22. **Trunk** (noun) – main stem, body, column, shaft, bole पेड़ का तना
23. **Determination** (noun) – resolve, firmness, perseverance, tenacity, willpower दृढ़ निश्चय
24. **Born out** (phrasal verb) – resulting from, arising from, caused by, stemming from, produced by से उत्पन्न

25. **Inch** (verb) – creep, edge, move slowly, advance gradually, crawl धीरे-धीरे बढ़ना
26. **Embrace** (verb) – hug, hold, clasp, cuddle, enfold गले लगाना
27. **Roar** (verb) – shout, bellow, yell, holler, thunder गरजना / दहाड़ना
28. **Advance** (verb) – move forward, proceed, progress, approach, march आगे बढ़ना
29. **Menacingly** (adverb) – threateningly, dangerously, ominously, intimidatingly, fearfully डराने वाले अंदाज़ में
30. **Get down** (phrasal verb) – descend, dismount, step down, alight, drop नीचे उतरना
31. **Paralyse** (verb) – immobilise, disable, cripple, incapacitate, numb लकवाग्रस्त करना



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